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CUET UG

History

Mahatma Gandhi and National Movements

Civil Disobedience, Mass Mobilisation, and the Making of Free India (1915–1948)

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Module 1: The South African Laboratory & Emergence in India (1915–1918)

1.1 The South African Crucible (1893–1914)

Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi's political philosophy and techniques of mass mobilization were forged in South Africa, where he arrived in 1893 as legal counsel for Dada Abdulla & Co. Over two decades, he led Indian indentured laborers and merchants against racial discrimination.

- **Moderate Phase (1893–1906):** Founded the **Natal Indian Congress** (1894) and published **Indian Opinion** (1903). Inspired by John Ruskin's *Unto This Last*, he founded the **Phoenix Settlement** (1904) near Durban, enshrining the dignity of manual labor.
- **Satyagraha Phase (1906–1914):** Formulated **Satyagraha** (Truth-Force and Active Non-Violence) against the Asiatic Registration Act (1906). Founded **Tolstoy Farm** (1910) near Johannesburg with Hermann Kallenbach. Led the 1913 Great March against the £3 poll tax and invalidation of non-Christian marriages, culminating in the Indian Relief Act of 1914.

CUET HIGH-YIELD: CORE INTELLECTUAL INFLUENCES

- **John Ruskin:** *Unto This Last* — Inspired **Sarvodaya** (Welfare of All) and dignity of labor.
- **Leo Tolstoy:** *The Kingdom of God Is Within You* — Non-violent resistance to state tyranny.
- **Henry David Thoreau:** *Civil Disobedience* — Moral duty to resist unjust laws.

1.2 Return to India and BHU Speech (1915–1916)

Gandhi returned to India on **9 January 1915** (*Pravasi Bharatiya Divas*). On the advice of his political mentor, **Gopal Krishna Gokhale**, he spent a year touring India by third-class train to observe the masses. In May 1915, he established the **Sabarmati Ashram** in Ahmedabad.

In February 1916, at the opening of the **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)**, Gandhi delivered his first major public address in India. Speaking before princes and Congress elites, he delivered a historic critique: **"There is no salvation for India unless you strip yourselves of this jewellery and hold it in trust for your countrymen... Our salvation can only come through the farmer."** This signaled a radical transition from elite politics to peasant mass mobilization.

1.3 The Triad of Local Satyagrahas (1917–1918)

Satyagraha & Year	Cause & Leaders	Outcome & Significance
Champaran (1917, Bihar)	Oppressive **Tinkathia system** (forced indigo cultivation on 3/20th land). Persuaded by **Rajkumar Shukla**; joined	First Civil Disobedience in India. Government inquiry abolished Tinkathia; planters refunded 25% of extorted money.

Satyagraha & Year	Cause & Leaders	Outcome & Significance
	by Rajendra Prasad, J.B. Kripalani.	
Ahmedabad Mill Strike (1918, Gujarat)	Dispute over **Plague Bonus** withdrawal. Workers demanded 50% wage hike; mill owners offered 20%. Supported by **Anusuya Sarabhai**.	First Hunger Strike. Gandhi secured an arbitrated settlement granting the workers a 35% wage increase.
Kheda Satyagraha (1918, Gujarat)	Drought caused harvest failure (under 25% normal yield). Authorities refused statutory revenue remission. Led with **Vallabhbhai Patel**.	First Non-Cooperation. Secret government order instructed collection only from those able to pay. Patel emerged as a national leader.

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Module 2: The Pan-Indian Surge: Rowlatt, Jallianwala Bagh & Khilafat

2.1 The Rowlatt Act & Satyagraha (1919)

In March 1919, the Imperial Legislative Council enacted the **Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act** (the **Rowlatt Act**), extending wartime emergency curbs. It authorized detention without warrant or trial for up to two years, secret tribunals, and no appeal (**"No Dalil, No Vakil, No Appeal"**). Non-official Indian members (Jinnah, Malaviya) resigned in protest.

Gandhi organized the **Satyagraha Sabha** in Bombay and proclaimed a nationwide **hartal on 6 April 1919**, inaugurating his first pan-Indian mass campaign.

2.2 The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (13 April 1919)

Agitation peaked in Punjab following the arrest and deportation of local leaders **Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlew** and **Dr. Satyapal** on 10 April 1919.

- **The Tragedy:** On **13 April 1919** (Baisakhi), thousands assembled peacefully at **Jallianwala Bagh** in Amritsar. **Brigadier-General Reginald Dyer** blocked the sole narrow exit with troops and opened fire without warning. 1,650 rounds were fired until ammunition was exhausted. Non-official estimates cited over 1,000 dead.
- **National Reaction: Rabindranath Tagore** renounced his British **Knighthood**, declaring that "badges of honour make our shame glaring." Gandhi surrendered his **Kaiser-i-Hind** gold medal. The Hunter Committee censured Dyer, but the British House of Lords praised him.

2.3 The Khilafat Alliance (1919–1920)

Post-WWI dismemberment of the Ottoman Empire under the Treaty of Sèvres threatened the temporal authority of the **Caliph** (Khalifa). Brothers **Maulana Mohammad Ali** and **Shaukat**

Ali (the Ali Brothers) formed the **All-India Khilafat Committee**. Gandhi saw this as an unmatched opportunity to unite Hindus and Muslims, linking the Khilafat and Punjab wrongs with the demand for **Swaraj**.

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Module 3: Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–1922)

3.1 Launch and Program of the Movement

Launched on **1 August 1920** (the day Bal Gangadhar Tilak passed away), the movement was ratified at the Calcutta Special Session (Sept 1920) and Nagpur Annual Session (Dec 1920, resolution moved by **C.R. Das**). Congress altered its goal to attaining **Swaraj through peaceful and legitimate means**.

- **Boycott (Negative Agenda):** Surrender of titles/honours; boycott of courts, government schools/colleges, legislative elections (Act of 1919), and foreign textiles; public bonfires of imported cloth.
- **Constructive (Positive Agenda):** Establishment of national schools (**Jamia Millia Islamia**, **Kashi Vidyapeeth**, **Gujarat Vidyapeeth**); setting up arbitration panchayats; popularising the **Charkha** and **Khadi**; collection of over ₹1 crore in the **Tilak Swaraj Fund**; anti-untouchability and prohibition of liquor.

3.2 Regional Dimensions & Subaltern Upsurge

The movement inspired spontaneous peasant, tribal, and labor struggles:

- **Awadh (UP):** Peasant mobilization under **Baba Ramchandra** and the Oudh Kisan Sabha against taluqdars; Madari Pasi's **Eka Movement** (1921).
- **Andhra Hills:** Tribal guerrilla revolt in the Rampa region led by **Alluri Sitarama Raju** against oppressive colonial forest laws.
- **Assam:** Massive strikes across tea plantations with coolies deserting gardens chanting "Gandhi Maharaj ki Jai".
- **Punjab:** Sikh reformers led the **Akali Movement** to liberate gurdwaras from corrupt mahants.

3.3 Chauri Chaura & The Historic Trial (1922)

On **4 February 1922**, at **Chauri Chaura** (Gorakhpur district, UP), police fired on a peaceful procession. The enraged crowd torched the police station, killing **22 policemen**. Gandhi suspended the movement immediately via the **Bardoli Resolution** (12 February 1922).

Gandhi was arrested on 10 March 1922 and tried before **Judge C.N. Broomfield** in Ahmedabad. Gandhi pleaded guilty to sedition, declaring disaffection towards the British empire a moral duty. Broomfield sentenced him to 6 years imprisonment with profound respect. Gandhi was released early in 1924 on health grounds.



Figure 1: Comparative Structural Analysis of the Three Great Gandhian Mass Movements (NCM, CDM, QIM)

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Module 4: Constructive Work & Simon Boycott (1923–1929)

4.1 Swarajists vs. No-Changers

Following the suspension, Congress divided into two tactical camps at the 1922 Gaya Session:

- **Swarajists (Pro-Changers): C.R. Das** and **Motilal Nehru** founded the **Congress-Khilafat Swarajya Party** (Jan 1923) to enter legislative councils and wreck colonial governance from within. In 1925, **Vithalbhai Patel** was elected Speaker of the Central Legislative Assembly.
- **No-Changers: C. Rajagopalachari**, **Vallabhbhai Patel**, and **Rajendra Prasad** advocated dedicating all energy to rural constructive work.

Gandhi harmonized both factions in 1924, allowing council entry while he led rural revitalization through the **All-India Spinners' Association** (1925), Harijan upliftment, and national education.

4.2 Simon Commission and Nehru Report (1927–1928)

- **Simon Commission:** Appointed in Nov 1927 under **Sir John Simon** to evaluate constitutional progress; all seven members were British. Greeted on 3 Feb 1928 with nationwide strikes and chants of **"Simon Go Back!"** On 30 Oct 1928 in Lahore, **Lala Lajpat Rai** was brutally lathi-charged and died on 17 Nov 1928, declaring: **"Every blow on my back is a nail in the coffin of the British Empire."**
- **Nehru Report (1928):** Drafted by an All-Parties committee under **Motilal Nehru**; demanded **Dominion Status**, joint electorates with minority seat reservation, fundamental

rights, and adult suffrage. Rejected by Jinnah (who issued his **14 Points**) and opposed by young radicals (Jawaharlal Nehru, Subhas Chandra Bose) who demanded complete independence.

4.3 The Lahore Congress: Purna Swaraj (1929)

In December 1929, under the presidency of **Jawaharlal Nehru**, the Congress held its historic session on the banks of the Ravi at Lahore:

1. Passed the resolution declaring **Purna Swaraj** (Complete Independence) as the national objective.
2. Authorized Gandhi to launch the Civil Disobedience Movement.
3. Hoisted the tricolor flag at midnight on **31 December 1929**.
4. Fixed **26 January 1930** as the first **Purna Swaraj Day** (Independence Day).

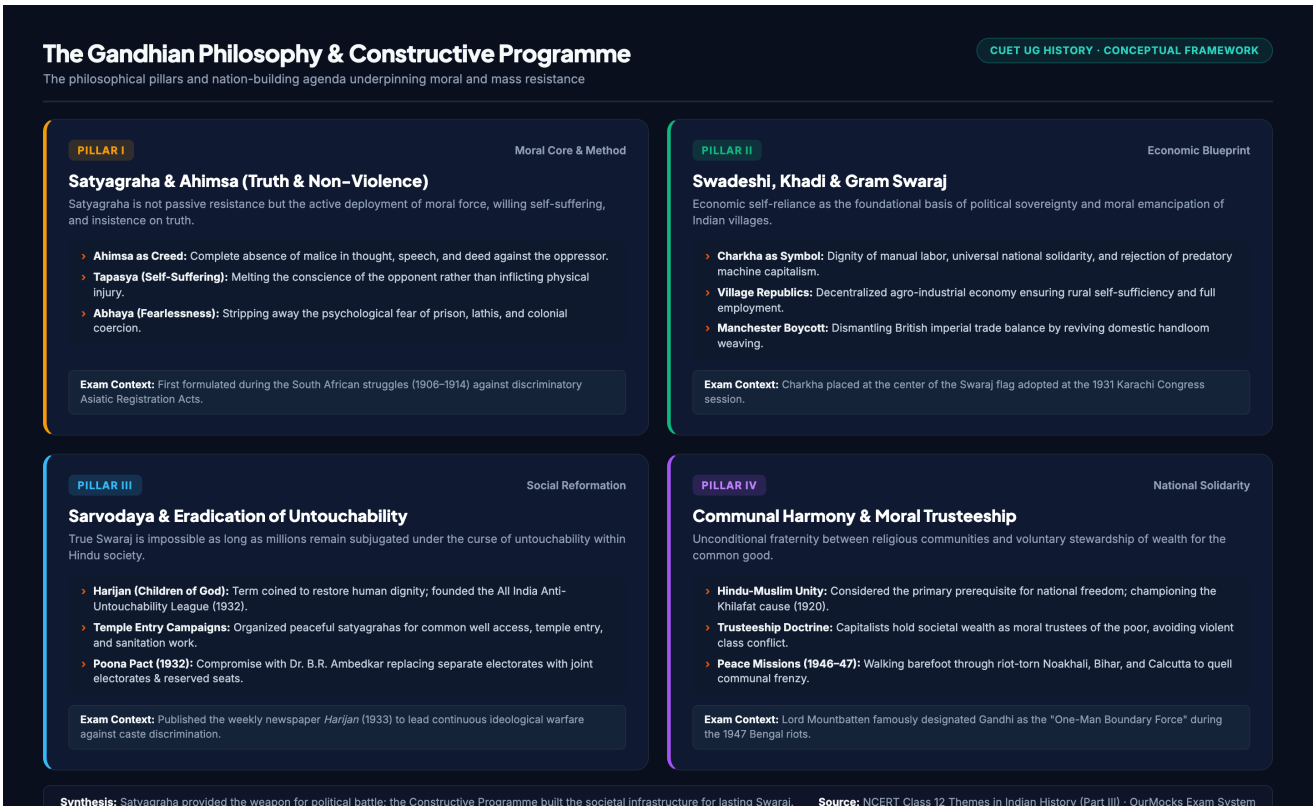


Figure 2: The Four Philosophical Pillars and Constructive Agenda of Gandhian Leadership

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Module 5: Civil Disobedience Movement & RTC Negotiations (1930–1934)

5.1 The Salt Satyagraha & Dandi March (1930)

After Viceroy Irwin rejected Gandhi's **Eleven Demands** (including abolition of the salt tax and 50% land revenue cut), Gandhi selected the **Salt Law** as the catalyst of rebellion. Salt was an indispensable necessity for all classes, and the state monopoly heavily taxed the poor while preventing natural collection along India's coasts.

- **The March:** On **12 March 1930**, Gandhi and **78 ashramites** departed Sabarmati Ashram, marching **240 miles** across Gujarat in 24 days.
- **The Invalidation:** On **6 April 1930**, Gandhi collected a handful of salt from the Dandi shore, declaring: **"With this, I am shaking the foundations of the British Empire."**

5.2 Pan-Indian Spread of Defiance

Region	Leadership	Form of Action
Peshawar (NWFP)	**Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan** ("Frontier Gandhi")	Non-violent volunteer brigade **Khudai Khidmatgars** ("Red Shirts"). Troops of the **Garhwal Rifles** refused orders to fire on unarmed demonstrators.
Tamil Nadu & Kerala	**C. Rajagopalachari** & **K. Kelappan**	Rajaji led the **Vedaranyam Salt March** (Tiruchirappalli to Vedaranyam). Kelappan led the march from Calicut to Payyanur in Malabar.
Dharasana (Gujarat)	**Sarojini Naidu**, **Imam Saheb**, **Manilal Gandhi**	Disciplined non-violent raid on salt pans on 21 May 1930. Satyagrahis were systematically clubbed; reported globally by American journalist Webb Miller.
Eastern & Central India	Peasants & Tribals	Non-payment of **Chowkidari Tax** in Bihar; violation of **Forest Laws** in Central Provinces, Maharashtra, and Karnataka.

Women's Participation: Women stepped out in thousands under leaders like **Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay** and **Sarojini Naidu**, picketing liquor and cloth shops and facing arrests.

5.3 Round Table Conferences & The Poona Pact (1931–1932)

1. **First RTC (1930–31):** Chaired by Ramsay MacDonald; boycotted by Congress.
2. **Gandhi-Irwin Pact (Delhi Pact, 5 March 1931):** Release of non-violent prisoners; right to make salt for domestic use; suspension of CDM; Congress agreed to attend the Second RTC. Endorsed at the **Karachi Congress (March 1931)** under Sardar Patel, which also passed landmark resolutions on **Fundamental Rights** and the **National Economic Programme**.
3. **Second RTC (Sept–Dec 1931):** Gandhi attended as sole Congress representative. Rebuffed by imperialists and stalled by communal deadlocks. Returned to India and resumed Civil Disobedience amidst ruthless repression by Viceroy Willingdon.

4. **Communal Award & Poona Pact (1932):** In August 1932, Ramsay MacDonald granted **Separate Electorates to Depressed Classes**. Gandhi undertook a fast unto death in Yerwada Jail on 20 September 1932, viewing separate electorates as a device to split Hindu society.
   - On **24 September 1932**, the **Poona Pact** was signed between **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar** and caste Hindu leaders.
   - Separate electorates were abandoned in favor of **Joint Electorates with Reserved Seats**.
   - Reserved seats in provincial legislatures increased from **71 to 148**. Gandhi subsequently founded the **Harijan Sevak Sangh** and launched the weekly **Harijan** (1933).

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Module 6: World War II, Cripps Mission & Quit India Movement (1939–1945)

6.1 Resignation of Ministries (1939)

Under the **Government of India Act 1935**, Congress had formed ministries in 8 provinces in 1937. On 3 September 1939, Britain declared India a belligerent in WWII without consulting Indian representatives. Congress ministries resigned in protest in Oct–Nov 1939. The Muslim League celebrated **22 December 1939** as the **"Day of Deliverance"**. In October 1940, Gandhi launched **Individual Satyagraha** (**Vinoba Bhave** was the first satyagrahi; **Jawaharlal Nehru** was second).

6.2 Cripps Mission (March 1942)

Facing Japanese advances at India's eastern border, British PM Winston Churchill sent cabinet minister **Sir Stafford Cripps** to India. Cripps offered post-war Dominion status, a constitution-making body, and a clause permitting provinces to secede. Congress rejected it for offering post-war promises and enabling partition. Gandhi dismissed it as a **"post-dated cheque on a crashing bank"**.

6.3 Quit India Movement (August 1942)

On **8 August 1942**, the AICC met at **Gowalia Tank Ground** in Bombay, ratifying the **Quit India Resolution**. Gandhi issued his clarion call: **"Do or Die"** (**Karo ya Maro**).

- **Operation Zero Hour:** Before dawn on 9 August 1942, all senior leaders were arrested. Gandhi was interned at the Aga Khan Palace (Pune); the Working Committee in Ahmednagar Fort.
- **Spontaneous Surge:** Widespread attacks on railways, telegraph lines, post offices, and police stations.
- **Underground Heroes: Jayaprakash Narayan** and Ram Manohar Lohia organized the **Azad Dasta**; **Aruna Asaf Ali** hoisted the tricolor at Gowalia Tank; **Dr. Usha Mehta** operated the clandestine **Secret Congress Radio**.
- **Parallel Governments (Prati Sarkars):**

- **Ballia (UP):** Under **Chittu Pandey** (August 1942).
- **Tamluk (Midnapore, Bengal): Tamluk Jatiya Sarkar** (1942–44) with its armed corps, the **Vidyut Vahinis**.
- **Satara (Maharashtra): Prati Sarkar** under **Nana Patil** and Y.B. Chavan (lasted until 1945) running people's courts.

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Module 7: Decolonization, Partition, Independence & Martyrdom (1946–1948)

7.1 Cabinet Mission & Communal Crisis (1946)

In 1946, the British Labour government under Clement Attlee sent the **Cabinet Mission** (Pethick-Lawrence, Cripps, Alexander). It proposed a three-tier federation and provincial grouping, rejecting an independent Pakistan. Following disputes over grouping, the Muslim League launched **Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946**, triggering the **Great Calcutta Killings** and widespread riots.

7.2 The "One-Man Boundary Force" & Martyrdom

- **Noakhali & Calcutta Missions:** While leaders negotiated partition, Gandhi walked barefoot through riot-torn **Noakhali** (Nov 1946 – March 1947) and held peace fasts in Calcutta during August–September 1947. Lord Mountbatten saluted him as the **"One-Man Boundary Force"** who kept peace where 55,000 troops failed in Punjab.
- **Final Fast in Delhi (Jan 1948):** Gandhi fasted to restore peace for Delhi's Muslims and demanded India release ₹55 crore in cash balances due to Pakistan under partition terms.
- **Martyrdom:** On **30 January 1948**, on his way to evening prayer at **Birla House** (New Delhi), Gandhi was shot dead by **Nathuram Godse**. Jawaharlal Nehru addressed the bereaved nation: **"The light has gone out of our lives and there is darkness everywhere."**

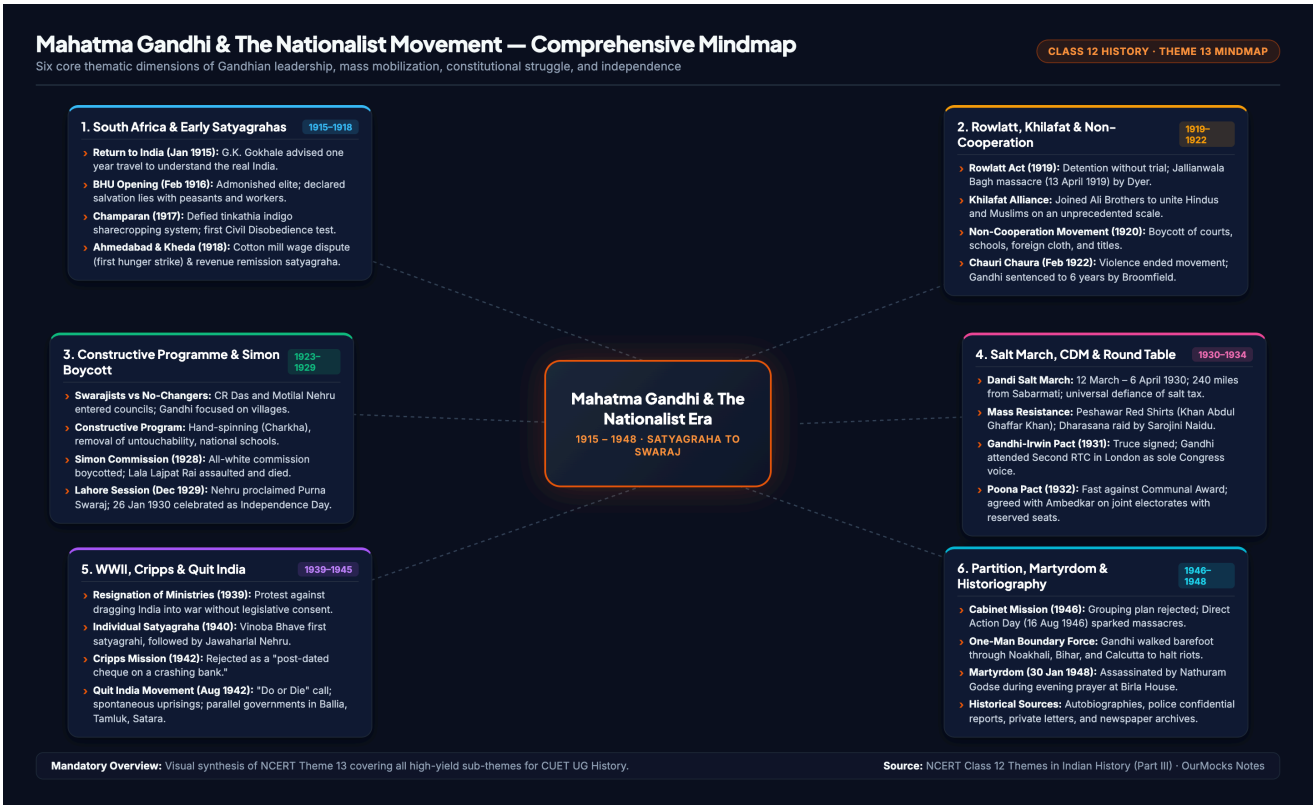


Figure 3: Comprehensive Mindmap: The Thematic Pillars of the Gandhian Nationalist Era (1915–1948)

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Module 8: Historiography & Primary Sources

Source	Key Evidence	Historiographical Limitation
Speeches & Writings	The **Collected Works of Mahatma Gandhi** (approx. 100 volumes); periodicals **Young India**, **Harijan**, **Navajivan**.	Addressed specific political audiences; aimed at building broad moral consensus rather than technical strategy.
Private Letters & Diaries	Correspondence with Nehru, Patel, Tagore, Romain Rolland; diaries of personal secretary **Mahadev Desai**.	Must be cross-examined against public actions; often reflect private anxieties and temporary tactical doubt.
Autobiographical Works	**The Story of My Experiments with Truth** (covers life up to 1920) and **Satyagraha in South Africa**.	Retrospective personal reflection focused on moral evolution rather than an objective chronological record.

Source	Key Evidence	Historiographical Limitation
Colonial Police Records	**Fortnightly Reports (FR)** of Home Department; Intelligence Bureau (IB) files and CID dossiers.	Viewed nationalist movements as manipulated conspiracies, consistently underestimating spontaneous moral support.

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Practice Questions: CUET UG Format

Q1. At which of the following events did Mahatma Gandhi make his first major public appearance in India after returning from South Africa in 1915?

(A) Opening ceremony of the Banaras Hindu University (February 1916)
(B) Champaran Satyagraha inquiry committee meeting (April 1917)
(C) Lucknow Session of the Indian National Congress (December 1916)
(D) Calcutta Special Session of the Indian National Congress (September 1920)

Sol. Q1. Gandhi's first major public appearance on an Indian political platform occurred in February 1916 at the opening of Banaras Hindu University (BHU), where he famously rebuked the assembled princes and elites for their indifference towards the impoverished peasantry.

Answer: (A)

Q2. Which book profoundly transformed Gandhi's economic outlook and led directly to the establishment of the Phoenix Settlement in South Africa in 1904?

(A) Henry David Thoreau's **Civil Disobedience**
(B) John Ruskin's **Unto This Last**
(C) Leo Tolstoy's **The Kingdom of God Is Within You**
(D) Karl Marx's **Das Kapital**

Sol. Q2. Gandhi translated Ruskin's **Unto This Last** as **Sarvodaya**. Its central thesis—that the good of the individual is contained in the good of all and that the life of manual labor is the most noble—inspired the founding of Phoenix Settlement.

Answer: (B)

Q3. Arrange the following early satyagrahas led by Mahatma Gandhi in India in the correct chronological sequence:

1. Kheda Satyagraha
2. Champaran Satyagraha
3. Ahmedabad Textile Mill Strike

(A) $2 \to 1 \to 3$ **(B)** $1 \to 2 \to 3$
(C) $2 \to 3 \to 1$ **(D)** $3 \to 2 \to 1$

Sol. Q3. The correct chronological order is: Champaran Satyagraha (1917) → Ahmedabad Mill Strike (March 1918) → Kheda Satyagraha (June 1918). Hence, $2 \to 3 \to 1$.

Answer: (C)

Q4. Rabindranath Tagore renounced his British Knighthood in May 1919 as an immediate protest against which colonial atrocity?

(A) The passage of the Rowlatt Act by the Imperial Legislative Council
(B) The execution of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru at Lahore
(C) The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre in Amritsar on 13 April 1919
(D) The police brutality during the Simon Commission protests in Lahore

Sol. Q4. Rabindranath Tagore surrendered his Knighthood in a historic letter to Viceroy Chelmsford following the brutal Jallianwala Bagh massacre perpetrated by Brigadier-General Dyer on 13 April 1919.

Answer: (C)

Q5. Who among the following moved the official resolution on the Non-Cooperation Movement at the historic Nagpur Session of the Indian National Congress in December 1920?

(A) Lala Lajpat Rai **(B)** Chitta Ranjan (C.R.) Das
(C) Motilal Nehru **(D)** Mahatma Gandhi

Sol. Q5. At the Nagpur Annual Session in December 1920, C.R. Das, who had initially opposed the Non-Cooperation resolution at the Calcutta Special Session, supported Gandhi and moved the main resolution.

Answer: (B)

Q6. The tragic Chauri Chaura incident, which prompted Mahatma Gandhi to suspend the Non-Cooperation Movement in February 1922, took place in which modern district of Uttar Pradesh?

(A) Varanasi **(B)** Gorakhpur
(C) Allahabad (Prayagraj) **(D)** Faizabad (Ayodhya)

Sol. Q6. The Chauri Chaura incident occurred on 4 February 1922 in Gorakhpur district, Uttar Pradesh, where 22 police constables were burnt alive inside a police station by an agitated crowd, leading Gandhi to pass the Bardoli withdrawal resolution on 12 February 1922.

Answer: (B)

Q7. Who among the following was elected as the first Indian President (Speaker) of the Central Legislative Assembly in 1925 as a triumph of Swarajist council-entry strategy?

(A) Motilal Nehru
(B) Vithalbhai J. Patel
(C) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(D) Sachchidananda Sinha

Sol. Q7. Vithalbhai Patel, the elder brother of Vallabhbhai Patel and a prominent Swarajist leader, was elected President of the Central Legislative Assembly in 1925.

Answer: (B)

Q8. At which session of the Indian National Congress was the historic **Purna Swaraj** (Complete Independence) resolution formally adopted under the presidency of Jawaharlal Nehru?

(A) Madras Session (1927)
(B) Calcutta Session (1928)
(C) Lahore Session (1929)
(D) Karachi Session (1931)

Sol. Q8. The Purna Swaraj resolution was adopted at the historic Lahore Congress Session in December 1929 under Jawaharlal Nehru, fixing 26 January 1930 as the first Independence Day.

Answer: (C)

Q9. How many chosen followers accompanied Mahatma Gandhi on the commencement of the historic Dandi Salt March from Sabarmati Ashram on 12 March 1930?

(A) 72 followers
(B) 78 followers
(C) 84 followers
(D) 100 followers

Sol. Q9. Gandhi commenced the 240-mile march from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi with exactly 78 dedicated ashram inmates on 12 March 1930.

Answer: (B)

Q10. Who led the heroic salt march from Tiruchirappalli to Vedaranyam along the Coromandel Coast in Tamil Nadu during the Civil Disobedience Movement?

(A) K. Kelappan
(B) C. Rajagopalachari
(C) E.V. Ramasamy Periyar
(D) Subramania Bharati

Sol. Q10. C. Rajagopalachari (Rajaji) led the famous Vedaranyam Salt March in Tamil Nadu in April 1930, mirroring Gandhi's Dandi march in Gujarat.

Answer: (B)

Q11. The historic **Poona Pact** signed on 24 September 1932 resulted in which of the following arrangements between Dr. B.R. Ambedkar and caste Hindu leaders?

(A) Acceptance of Separate Electorates for Depressed Classes as outlined in the Communal Award
(B) Abandonment of Separate Electorates in exchange for Joint Electorates with increased Reserved Seats
(C) Creation of an independent statutory council for the administration of Depressed Class regions
(D) Total reservation of 50% seats in all provincial and central legislatures for Scheduled Castes

Sol. Q11. The Poona Pact abandoned Ramsay MacDonald's Communal Award provisions of separate electorates for Depressed Classes in favor of joint electorates with increased reserved seats (from 71 to 148 seats in provincial legislatures).

Answer: (B)

Q12. Which historic session of the Indian National Congress adopted the famous resolutions on **Fundamental Rights** and the **National Economic Programme** drafted by Jawaharlal Nehru?

(A) Lahore Session (1929)
(B) Karachi Session (1931)
(C) Lucknow Session (1936)
(D) Faizpur Session (1937)

Sol. Q12. The Karachi Congress Session of March 1931, presided over by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, passed the historic resolutions on Fundamental Rights and the National Economic Programme.

Answer: (B)

Q13. During the Quit India Movement of 1942, an armed volunteer corps known as the **Vidyut Vahinis** was organized under which of the following parallel governments?

(A) The Prati Sarkar of Satara in Maharashtra
(B) The Tamluk Jatiya Sarkar of Midnapore in Bengal
(C) The Independent Sarkar of Ballia in Uttar Pradesh
(D) The Talcher Swarajya Panchayat in Orissa

Sol. Q13. The Tamluk Jatiya Sarkar (formed in Midnapore district, Bengal, in December 1942 under Satish Chandra Samanta) organized an armed volunteer corps called the **Vidyut Vahinis** (Lightning Brigades).

Answer: (B)

Q14. Who among the following nationalist women operated the clandestine **Secret Congress Radio** that broadcasted news of the Quit India rebellion from hidden locations in Bombay?

(A) Aruna Asaf Ali
(B) Dr. Usha Mehta
(C) Sucheta Kripalani
(D) Captain Lakshmi Sahgal

Sol. Q14. Dr. Usha Mehta, alongside Babubhai Khakar, operated the clandestine Secret Congress Radio during the 1942 Quit India Movement until arrested in November 1942.

Answer: (B)

Q15. Viceroy Lord Mountbatten famously designated Mahatma Gandhi as the **"One-Man Boundary Force"** during the tragic days of 1947 because:

(A) Gandhi single-handedly demarcated the international boundary line between India and Pakistan in Bengal
(B) Gandhi commanded a private army of nationalist volunteers that guarded the refugee camps along the Punjab border
(C) Gandhi's moral presence and heroic peace fasts quelled communal violence in Bengal where 55,000 soldiers had failed in Punjab
(D) Gandhi successfully persuaded the Muslim League and Congress to sign the Mountbatten Plan without partition

Sol. Q15. Lord Mountbatten hailed Gandhi as the "One-Man Boundary Force" because Gandhi's barefoot peace missions in Noakhali and his fast in Calcutta preserved communal peace in Bengal, achieving what 55,000 armed soldiers were unable to achieve in Punjab.

Answer: (C)